Ian Smart
Assistant Director
Immigration, Refugees and Citizenship Canada

To Whom It May Concern,

I am pleased to provide this letter of reference for Alin Sever, who worked on my team under my direction for approximately two years as a Senior Data Analyst. During that time, he distinguished himself as a highly capable and dependable professional, combining strong technical expertise with sound judgment, initiative, and a clear commitment to continuous improvement.

Alin was a trusted member of the team whose work consistently met a high standard of quality and rigour. He operated with a high degree of independence and accountability, and I relied on him to deliver complex analytical work under tight timelines, with full confidence in both the integrity of his data and the conclusions he drew. His professionalism, discretion, and reliability made him someone I entrusted with important and complex files.

A defining strength of Alin's work was his ability to move beyond descriptive analysis and generate insights that informed decision-making. He brought a disciplined, analytical mindset to complex problems, approaching them in a structured and methodical way. His analyses were both technically sound and outcomes-focused, helping to clarify issues, identify root causes, and support practical, evidence-based solutions.

Alin consistently demonstrated initiative and strong strategic awareness. He did not limit himself to assigned tasks; rather, he proactively identified opportunities to deepen analysis and enhance the value of his work by examining issues from multiple perspectives. This was particularly evident in his development of a comprehensive inventory dashboard in R, which provided senior management and operational networks with meaningful visibility into file movement, bottlenecks, and processing pressures. The tool generated actionable insights that contributed to improved service standard performance and strengthened operational oversight.

He also applied his analytical expertise to more complex, risk-based work, including the development of tools to identify potential indicators of fraud based on historical application patterns. This work required not only technical proficiency, but also sound judgment in selecting appropriate methodologies and interpreting results responsibly. His contributions supported more proactive monitoring and strengthened program integrity.

Alin was an effective communicator who understood how to position analysis so that it resonated with decision-makers. He translated complex findings into clear, concise, and relevant messages, adapting his approach to both technical and non-technical audiences. His work helped support clarity and facilitated informed discussions at all levels of the organization.

From a technical standpoint, Alin demonstrated strong proficiency in a range of tools, including Excel, Cognos, R, and Power BI. He was skilled across the full analytical lifecycle - from data extraction and preparation through to analysis and visualization - and consistently produced work that was both reliable and accessible.

In summary, Alin is a thoughtful and results-oriented analyst who brings together technical strength, initiative, and sound judgment. His ability to deliver meaningful insights, coupled with his reliability and professionalism, makes him a valuable asset to any organization. I recommend him without hesitation.

Please do not hesitate to contact me should you require further information.

Sincerely,
Ian Smart

Smart, Ian

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